# TINIDAZOLE

No alcohol (72 h after)

Single-dose regimens

**CHEMICAL NAME** 1-[2-(ethylsulfonyl)ethyl]-2-methyl-5-nitro-1H-imidazole
**CLASS** Nitroimidazole antiprotozoal and antibacterial
**TRADE NAMES** Fasigyn · Tindamax · Tiniba

## THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Giardiasis, amoebiasis (intestinal and liver abscess).
- Trichomoniasis (single dose).
- Bacterial vaginosis.
- *H. pylori* eradication; anaerobic infections.

## ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** with food to reduce GI upset.
- Tablets may be crushed in cherry syrup for children.

## DOSAGES

- **Giardiasis / trichomoniasis:** 2 g single dose (treat partner).
- **Intestinal amoebiasis:** 2 g once daily for 3 days.
- **Amoebic liver abscess:** 2 g once daily for 3–5 days.
- **Children (>3 yr):** 50 mg/kg once (max 2 g).

## PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 2 h. Bioavailability ~100%.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP3A4).
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** 12–14 h (longer than metronidazole).

## PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Reduced to cytotoxic intermediates in anaerobes/protozoa → DNA damage → cell death.

## SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

### SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Metallic taste, nausea, anorexia.
- Headache, fatigue.
- Dark urine.

### ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Disulfiram-like reaction with alcohol.
- Peripheral neuropathy, seizures (rare).
- Transient leucopenia.

## CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Nitroimidazole hypersensitivity.
- First trimester of pregnancy; breastfeeding (stop for 72 h).
- Organic neurological disorders; blood dyscrasias.

### KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Alcohol (during and 72 h after):** flushing, vomiting.
- **Warfarin:** ↑ INR.
- **Lithium, ciclosporin, fluorouracil:** ↑ levels.

## NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Check pregnancy status.
- Explain alcohol avoidance clearly.
- Make sure partner treatment for trichomoniasis.
- Monitor for neurological symptoms.
- Stool examination follow-up for parasites.

## PATIENT EDUCATION

- No alcohol for 3 days after the dose.
- Take with food.
- Partners must be treated at the same time.
- Report numbness or tingling.

## KEY POINTS

- Longer-acting nitroimidazole — single-dose cures.
- No alcohol for 72 h.
- Giardia, Trichomonas, amoebiasis.
- Avoid in 1st trimester.

**SOURCES CHECKED** **[192]** Tinidazole, oral (US label) **[193]** Tindamax, oral (US label)

*Full references p. 432–457*